





Sculpting the Shadows

In Ahmedabad's blistering 42-degree summers, architecture must act as an active shield. For Abhikram, an eco-conscious residence, Khosla Associates turned climate response into the primary driver of form. The structure negotiates with the fierce sun through deep verandahs, horizontal pergolas and vertical louvers that filter harsh light while promoting cross-ventilation.

The double-height living space features permeable east and west verandahs to capture breezes. The western porch integrates two existing neem trees for natural shade, while its north wall features grooved pink sandstone. To prevent heat absorption, 80 per cent of the roofs are clad in clay tiles, glass expanses are minimised, and southern bedrooms utilise double walls to block thermal transfer.

Sustainability is anchored by natural, locally sourced materials including regional clay bricks, cast-in-situ beige terrazzo, Kota stone and reclaimed timber. Doors and windows utilise sustainable plantation Accoya wood. This layout allows summer breezes to pass over the eastern pool, cooling the living zones naturally. Furthermore, abundant filtered daylight eliminates the need for light bulbs during the day.

Experientially, a sculptural Corten steel staircase leads to a 30 ft bridge spanning the living volume. Overhead, three trapezoidal roofs admit soft northern light. Their warm wood veneer contrasts with the cool terrazzo floors below, proving that deep environmental responsibility can inhabit a striking, luxurious footprint.